

FILM DOSSIER: AVENGERS: TIME RUNS OUT

Phase 5 · Film #10, the Phase 5 finale (Saga Two, Film #19 · Overall Film #48)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Film #	Saga Two #19 (Phase 5, Film #10, the finale) · MCU #48
Phase	Phase 5, The Secret Wars Saga : "Time Runs Out"
Real title	<i>AVENGERS: TIME RUNS OUT</i> (the name of the 616 storyline and of the phase)
Decoy / codename title	" <i>LAST CALL</i> "
Release date	Friday, December 17, 2027 . A holiday event release, and the last Marvel film before Secret Wars
Distributor	Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures
Directors	Anthony & Joe Russo (returning from The Infinity Gauntlet and Avengers Forever)
Rating / runtime	PG-13 · 181 minutes
Genre + second genre	Superhero action-adventure + apocalypse film / civil war tragedy

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose film / franchise is this?	THE AVENGERS ensemble . It's co-led by MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK (Iron Man, leading the Illuminati) and TYRESE AVERY (Steve Rogers, leading the Avengers). Robert Downey Jr. is billed third.

Character	Side	Actor	Age at release
Tony Stark / Iron Man	The Illuminati	Marc-Anthony Bullock	45
Steve Rogers	The Avengers (leader)	Tyrese Avery	46
Bucky Barnes / Captain America	The Avengers	Sebastian Stan	45
Thor	The Avengers	Esther Smiley	45
The Hulk / Bruce Banner	The Avengers (<i>released for the war</i>)	Amond Baker	45
Natasha Romanoff / Black Widow	The Avengers	Harmony Divine	45
Claire Barton / Hawkeye	The Avengers	Arianna Cummings	45
Wanda Maximoff / The Scarlet Witch	The Avengers	Grace Bullock	43
Janet van Dyne / The Wasp	The Avengers	Elxa Bullock	47
Hank Pym / Ultron (<i>the merged hybrid; a cameo</i>)	–	Tyler Chapman	45
Pepper Potts	–	Tayia Boyd	45
Sam Wilson / The Falcon	The Avengers	Anthony Mackie	49
The Vision	The Avengers	Paul Bettany	56
Scott Lang / Ant-Man	The Avengers	Paul Rudd	58
Carol Danvers / Captain Marvel	The Avengers	Brie Larson	38
Monica Rambeau	The Avengers	Teyonah Parris	40
Kamala Khan / Ms. Marvel	The Avengers	Iman Vellani	25
Peter Parker / Spider-Man	The Avengers	Tom Holland	31
Maria Hill (<i>Director of S.H.I.E.L.D.</i>)	S.H.I.E.L.D.	Cobie Smulders	45
Reed Richards / Mr. Fantastic	The Illuminati	Pedro Pascal	52
Sue Storm / Invisible Woman	–	Vanessa Kirby	39
Ben Grimm / The Thing	–	Ebon Moss-Bachrach	50
Franklin & Valeria Richards	–	Fresh casting	–
Doctor Strange	The Illuminati → Doom	Benedict Cumberbatch	51
Shuri / Black Panther	The Illuminati	Letitia Wright	34

Character	Side	Actor	Age at release
Black Bolt	The Illuminati	Anson Mount	54
Hank McCoy / Beast	The Illuminati	Nicholas Hoult	38
Scott Summers / Cyclops	The X-Men	Tye Sheridan	31
Namor	The Cabal	Tenoch Huerta	46
Thanos	The Cabal	Josh Brolin	59
Maximus the Mad	The Cabal	Iwan Rheon	42
The Black Swan (Yabbith Hlaw)	The Cabal	Fresh casting	–
Proxima Midnight / Corvus Glaive / Terrax	The Cabal	Fresh casting	–
Victor von Doom	Doom	Robert Downey Jr.	62
Owen Reece / The Molecule Man	Doom	Fresh casting	–
The Maker (Earth-1610)	1610	Pedro Pascal	52
Miles Morales / Spider-Man (Earth-1610)	1610	Shameik Moore	32
Nick Fury (Earth-616, underground)	–	Samuel L. Jackson	78

In memoriam:

- **Chadwick Boseman (1976–2020)**. *T'Challa is not recast. Before the end, Shuri stands at T'Challa's tomb: "I kept your seat, brother. I'm sorry I couldn't keep the world."*

- **Stan Lee (1922–2018)**. *In the last minutes, as the sky falls, an elderly man on a New York street holds up a sign: ***"EXCELSIOR."*

- **William Hurt (1950–2022)** and **Ray Stevenson (1964–2023)** ***are not recast. Their names are on the S.H.I.E.L.D. memorial wall* that Steve passes in Act One.**

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	" <i>Time Runs Out</i> ," <i>Avengers</i> vol. 5 #35–44 and <i>New Avengers</i> vol. 3 #24–33 (2015), Jonathan Hickman with Stefano Caselli, Kev Walker, Mike Deodato and others: Steve Rogers leads the Avengers and S.H.I.E.L.D. in a hunt for the Illuminati. The Cabal (Namor, Thanos, the Black Swan, Maximus, Proxima Midnight, Corvus Glaive, Terrax) destroys other Earths. The Beyonders kill the Celestials and the Living Tribunal. Doom, Strange and the Molecule Man go beyond the multiverse to fight them. Namor turns on the Cabal. Steve and Tony fight in the ruins as the last Incursion arrives. <i>Secret Wars</i> #1 (2015), Hickman & Esad Ribić: the last Incursion, Earth-616 against Earth-1610. Reed's "Life Raft." Everything dies.
Supporting comics	<i>New Avengers</i> vol. 3 #1–23 (2013–14, the Illuminati and the Incursions) · <i>Avengers</i> vol. 5 #1–34 (2012–14) · <i>Ultimate Comics</i> (2011–15, the Maker)
Nerf check	☒ This is the MCU's largest battle: the Avengers, the Illuminati, the Cabal, and 1610's Maker. Nobody's held back. Thanos is at full power, and Namor turns the war. The Beyonders kill the Living Tribunal. Doom is the only thing in the multiverse strong enough to fight them. And even the heroes can't stop the multiverse from ending, as on 616.

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	95%. Hickman's <i>Time Runs Out</i> and <i>Secret Wars</i> #1 are adapted almost beat for beat, with the heroes adjusted to MCU continuity.

Straight from the page:

- Steve Rogers leads the Avengers, with S.H.I.E.L.D. under Maria Hill, to arrest the Illuminati (*Avengers* #35).
- Sam Wilson is at Steve's side (#35–44).
- The Cabal destroys other Earths without hesitation (*NA* #24–33).
- Namor turns on the Cabal, trapping them on a doomed Earth, and they survive (*NA* #29–33).
- The Beyonders kill the Celestials and the Living Tribunal (*Avengers* #43).
- Doom, Strange and the Molecule Man go beyond the multiverse to fight the Beyonders (*NA* #33).
- Steve and Tony fight as the last Incursion arrives (*Avengers* #44).
- Earth-616 vs. Earth-1610 (*SW* #1).
- Reed's Life Raft saves a handful of heroes (*SW* #1).
- Everything goes white (*SW* #1).

Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| Steve still has full serum strength (616: the Iron Nail had drained it, and he was an old man) | Nobody gets

nerfed. Steve fights Tony **at full strength.** |

| **Bucky is Cap**, not Sam (616: Sam) | MCU continuity (*Captain America: Reborn*). **Sam stays at Steve's side**, as on 616. |

| **Shuri, not T'Challa**, is in the Illuminati | In memory of Chadwick Boseman (real history) |

| **Tony already knows that Rabum Alal is Doom** | MCU continuity (*Iron Man: Doomquest*) |

| **Hank-Ultron** makes a **cameo** in space | His Phase 5 story (*Rage of Ultron*) |

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
Iron Man	Extremis armor	Full, including a new armor built for the end of the world	—	✓ 100%
Steve Rogers	Peak human	Beats Tony hand to hand, as on 616 , and the Helicarrier falls on them	—	✓ 100%
Thor	God-level; Mjolnir	Fights Thanos	—	✓ 100%
The Hulk	Limitless strength	Fights Terrax	—	✓ 100%
Thanos	Titan strength , a genius, Cabal leader	Fights Thor and the Hulk together	—	✓ 100%
Namor	Class 75–100 strength	Destroys a world with the Cabal on it	—	✓ 100%
Doom	Genius; sorcerer supreme-class ; the Beyonders' god-killing enemy	Walks into the Beyonders' realm	—	✓ 100%
The Molecule Man	Near-omnipotent control of matter and energy	The bomb in every universe	—	✓ 100%
Captain Marvel	Binary-level energy	Holds back an Earth for four seconds	—	✓ 100%
Scarlet Witch	Reality warping	Tries to rewrite the sky , and can't	—	✓ 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	The Avengers are hunting the Illuminati. The Cabal is destroying worlds. Doom has gone to kill God. And in four months the sky over New York will be another Earth.
Theme	Time runs out. There's no right answer left, only the people you choose to save.
Villain / antagonist	THE CABAL (Namor, Thanos) and the BEYONDERS ; Doom looms over everything

What the movie is about

ACT ONE: THE HUNT

- **Monday, August 2, 2027.** Steve Rogers leads the **Avengers** and **S.H.I.E.L.D.** (Maria Hill) in a **manhunt for the Illuminati**.
- **Earth-1610** fills the sky, **four and a half months from impact**.
- The **Illuminati**, in hiding, are building a **Life Raft**: Reed's lifeboat to **survive the end**.
- **The Cabal** has moved **to another universe's Earth** and is **destroying worlds** to save its own.
- **Tony** tells the Illuminati: "*Rabum Alal is Doom.*" Reed goes pale.

ACT TWO: GODS DIE

- **The Beyonders** kill **the Celestials**. Their corpses fall **across the sky**.
- **Doom, Strange and the Molecule Man** disappear **beyond the multiverse**. Tony: "*He's going to kill them. And then he's going to take what they had.*"
- **Namor**, sick of the Cabal, **traps it on a dying Earth** and **blows it up**, then **comes home**. **Shuri** won't forgive him.
- **The Cabal survives**. **Thanos** fights **Thor and the Hulk** together.
- **Carol** holds back **the other Earth** for **four seconds**.

ACT THREE: EVERYTHING DIES

- **Thursday, December 16, 2027.** The last day.
 - **Steve and Tony** fight **at last**, in the ruins of the Triskelion. **Steve wins, hand to hand**. Then **the Helicarrier falls on them both**.
 - **On 1610**, **Miles Morales** watches **Earth-616 fill the sky**. The Maker smiles.
 - **Reed's Life Raft** launches with a **handful of heroes**: **Reed, Shuri, Namor, Carol, Peter Parker, Thor, Cyclops, and the Black Swan**.
 - **Sue and the children don't make it**. Reed screams her name.
 - **11:59 p.m.** Two Earths **touch**. **Everything goes white**.
 - **TITLE CARD**: "*SECRET WARS.*"
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5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	Monday, August 2, 2027 → Thursday, December 16, 2027, 11:59 p.m. The multiverse ends the night before the film opens.
Where it's set	New York City (the Triskelion ruins, Avengers Mansion, the Baxter Building) · Wakanda · the Cabal's doomed Earth · Earth-1610 · beyond the multiverse
Relative to other films	It's the Phase 5 finale. It follows <i>Thor: The God Butcher</i> and runs alongside <i>Moon Knight</i> . The next thing that happens in the MCU is <i>Secret Wars</i> .

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The film's own world

- The multiverse is gone. So is Earth-616. Only the **Life Raft** is left.

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
The Life Raft	Its survivors	<i>Secret Wars</i>
Miles Morales survives	He was in a car when the Earths collided (SW #1–2)	<i>Secret Wars</i>

Setting up the Big Bad (THE SECRET WARS SAGA)

Seed	How it appears	What it means
Doom kills the Beyonders	Beyond the multiverse	He takes their power
"SECRET WARS"	The title card	Phase 6

7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

Field	Entry
Mid-credit scene	✓ "NOTHING." A white void. Mephisto , alone, his realm gone , sits with his head in his hands. Then, somewhere far away, a bell tolls . He looks up. " Victor? "
Post-credit scene	✓ "BATTLEWORLD." Eight months later . A patchwork world of dozens of broken realities . A Thor , one of hundreds of Thors , lands on a courtyard of Castle Doom . Doom , in white robes , sits on a throne at the top of a World Tree . At his side is Sue Storm, his queen , and Franklin and Valeria, his children . THOR : " <i>All hail God Doom.</i> " CUT TO BLACK. "THE SECRET WARS SAGA CONCLUDES IN PHASE 6."
Secret shoot codenames	Mid-credit: " BELL. " Post-credit: " KINGDOM COME. "

CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline